

continue to support Docker though, and has posted a development version of the software, ver 0.11, on GitHub.

Communications system used by Stephen Hawking goes open source!

From January 2015 onwards, millions of those who suffer from motor neurone disease worldwide will get access to an open source system that allows Stephen Hawking to communicate with the outside world. This decision, taken by Intel, was announced at a London press conference and the wheelchair-bound theoretical physicist, who became world famous in the 1980s with his book, 'A Brief History of Time', backed it.

The communications system has been open sourced by Intel and is called ACAT (Assistive Context Aware Toolkit). ACAT is a result of years of collaboration



between Intel and Hawking. Intel believes that the system is highly likely to become the 'spinal cord' of a modern, customisable system, which can now be used by all those who suffer from quadriplegia and other motor neurone related disabilities.

Hawking said at the press conference that this open source system will help millions of disabled people across the globe. He added that his earlier system was 20 years old now and its communicative functions were not very effective any more.

The new system has been a life-changing experience for him, and he believes it will serve him for the next 20 years. While speaking, Hawking's words were relayed by the robotic voice of his computer. At the age of 21, Hawking was diagnosed with a motor neurone disease related to amyotrophic lateral sclerosis (ALS). The open source communications system will be available online.

Opera offers a stable release for Linux users after 18 months

After a gap of 18 months, the first stable release of Opera is here for Linux and available for download too. The release is named Opera for Computers for Linux 26. It's a complete revamp in comparison to its predecessors.

New features have been added to the release and, thanks to the Aura and Blink features, the performance level has also improved. The new release has an impressive look and its engine works pretty fast, while maintaining all the standards.

The improved features include 'Discover', which shows articles from around the Web in different categories; 'Speed Dial', in support of widgets, folders and themes; 'Tab Peek', which offers a preview of an open tab; 'Opera Turbo', which offers the data-saving mode when patchy connections are in use; 'Bookmarking', 'Add-ons' as well as support to HiDPI displays on Linux.

If you are using Opera 12.6 on a 64-bit version of Ubuntu, then Canonical will automatically update your browser from the Ubuntu Software Center. A Debian installer can be downloaded from the Opera website too.



Debian now has a fork called Devuan



The Debian GNU/Linux project has a forked version now, as claimed by a group of veteran UNIX administrators. The fork has been named Devuan, and has come out as a response to Debian's decision to adopt systemd as the default init in its next release, Jessie.

In an official statement, the project leaders of Devuan said, "We believe this situation is also the result of a longer process leading to the takeover of Debian by the GNOME project agenda. Considering how far this has propagated today, and the importance of Debian as a universal OS and base system in the distribution panorama, what is at stake is the future of GNU/Linux in a scenario of complete homogenisation, and lock-in of all base distributions."

The statement also says that the main priority of this new project is to "...enable diversity, interoperability and backward compatibility for the existing Debian downstream willing to preserve init freedom and avoid the opaque and homogenising systemd avalanche." Debian's development is done in three streams – one is Wheezy, which is the current stable distribution, another is the testing stream and the last one is the unstable stream. Systemd can be operated in both the testing and unstable streams. In the next few months, if everything goes as planned, the testing stream will be released as the next stable release.